

CHT UI Builder — Squad Kickoff

v0.1 shipped · Squad meeting prep

A no-code editor that lets non-developers author, maintain, and deploy CHT app configurations — without touching XLSForm cell syntax, `tasks.js`, or the `cht` CLI.

NEED

Every CHT deployment needs a developer in the loop. Adding a survey question, inserting a hierarchy level, or shipping a follow-up task is engineering work — even when the change is operationally trivial. This bottlenecks CHT scaling to the long tail of district, NGO, and MoH deployments.

If a district health officer can change Excel, they should be able to change a CHT config.

VISION & MISSION

Vision (12–18 mo): Every CHT consultancy partner and Medic deployment can hand a project folder to a non-developer who can keep it healthy unattended — and deploy from the same tool.

Mission: A local-first editor that operates on real cht-conf folders, preserves everything it doesn't touch byte-for-byte, surfaces every "decision" the system makes for clinician sign-off, and ships through cht-conf with friendly errors.

TWO PRODUCT TRACKS — BOTH FIRST-CLASS

	EDIT EXISTING	START NEW
Who	Bhishan inheriting a config from a prior developer	Bhishan rolling out a new program (e.g. malaria screening)
Entry	Open project folder + folder browser	"🔮 Create new project..." wizard
Primary risk	Round-trip drift — silently corrupting someone's work	Producing an incomplete project the CHT app refuses to load
v0.1 status	Working 47 round-trip tests locked	Working 4 templates: Blank, Empty, Malaria, CHT-default

MVP OBJECTIVES — PICK 3 OF 5

- 1 **Non-dev edits existing config end-to-end** — Bhishan completes this form-edit unattended
- 2 **Non-dev scaffolds + deploys a new program** — malaria journey < 2 hours
- 3 **Edits round-trip byte-stable** — chis, gandaki, NSSD parse→serialize→parse equal
- 4 **Clinician signs off on every rule** — Decisions view aggregates appliesIf / context / calculation
- 5 **Deploy errors are intelligible** — top-10 cht-conf failures get plain-English summary

MVP SCOPE

- In already shipped
- Edit existing forms (survey, choices, settings, properties, translations)
 - Hierarchy editor with topological derivation + insert/reorder
 - Task editor (priority, appliesIf, events, actions builders)
 - Contact-summary context flags editor
 - Decisions (sign-off) aggregated view
 - Deploy: macros + friendly errors + dry-run + 4 templates
 - Undo across all editors + sticky chrome
- Out deliberate deferrals
- Live Enketo form preview (2-sprint project, post-MVP)
 - Contact-summary `fields[]` / `cards[]` editor
 - `targets.js`, pyxform-on-save, git integration, SMS forms
- Debate at the meeting** squad decision
- Form-XLSX generation in templates — in or out?
 - CI + Playwright fleet — in or post-MVP?
 - Live submission metrics from CHT — in or out?

PERSONAS (ACTIVE IN DOGFOOD LOOP)

- Bhishan KC** — DHO Gandaki, Excel-fluent, used Kobo once. Protects: *task completion*.
- Lal Bahadur** — UI/UX/HCD lead, 12 yrs. Protects: *affordance, microcopy, a11y*.
- Anita Tamang** — QA engineer, 6 yrs health-tech. Protects: *testability, regression safety, CI*.

Every v0.1 change ran through a 3-persona review before declaring done. Formalize this as the squad's change-review pattern.

Risks to hold in mind — Round-trip drift is the existential risk (one corrupted save erases trust). · Polish beats new features until destructive surfaces are predictable. · cht-conf v3.x → CHT 4.x version skew will rot the error-translator. · No CI-grade CHT-in-a-box means real bugs slip through.